Toronto Public Library
AI Literacy Framework Proposal

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*The goal of this framework is to equip TPL staff with literacy skills to use AI **effectively** and **ethically** in the workplace.*



Proposed Frames

IDENTIFY

Gain knowledge of AI tools, their outputs, basic skills, and relevant policies.

VALUE

Understand how bias, environmental, ethical, and legal concerns influence use of AI.

PARTICIPATE

Engage in ongoing, collective, and informed critical decision making around AI use.

APPLY

Utilize best practices to efficiently and effectively use AI and evaluate its output.

Frame Alignment

IDENTIFY

Awareness

Foundational Competencies 1, 4

VALUE

Understanding

Foundational Competencies 2, 3



PARTICIPATE

Application

Proficient Competencies 2, 3

Expert Competencies 1, 2, 3, 4

APPLY

Application

Proficient Competencies 1, 4

Expert Competencies 1, 4

Canadian Urban Libraries Council AI Staff Competency Framework (n.d.)

IDENTIFY **Hands-on Showcase**



- Primary audience: All staff, entry level learners
- Learning objectives:
  - Recognize common interfaces, and presence of AI in everyday life
  - Describe how AI works
  - Define common AI terminology
  - Identify AI policies & resources at TPL
- Assessment: Pre/Post Knowledge Check

What is AI? How is it used? What can it do?

VALUE Panel Discussion



- Primary audience: All staff, entry level learners
- Learning objectives:
  - Describe key points in the societal debate around AI, including bias and misinformation
  - Identify benefits and drawbacks of AI use
  - Recognize values behind AI policies at TPL
- Assessment: Case-based scenario questions

What does it mean to use AI ethically?
Why is this important?

APPLY **Prompt-a-thon**



- Primary audience: Emerging proficient learners
- Learning objectives:
  - Use AI to streamline tasks
  - Practice iterative prompting
  - Examine outputs for bias, inaccuracy, and harm
  - Explain disclosure and citation guidance
- Assessment: Prompt revision logs

How can AI be used to improve efficiency?
Are the outputs valid?

PARTICIPATE **Learning Circles**



- Primary audience: Proficient to expert learners
- Learning objectives:
  - Stay current on policies, issues, and perspectives
  - Apply AI creatively to solve problems
  - Shape shared standards and guardrails
  - Reassess tools over time
- Assessment: AI-based collaborative projects

What does continued ethical, efficient, innovative, and meaningful use of AI at TPL look like, now and going forward?

Framework Planning

Analyse baseline staff knowledge, confidence, skills

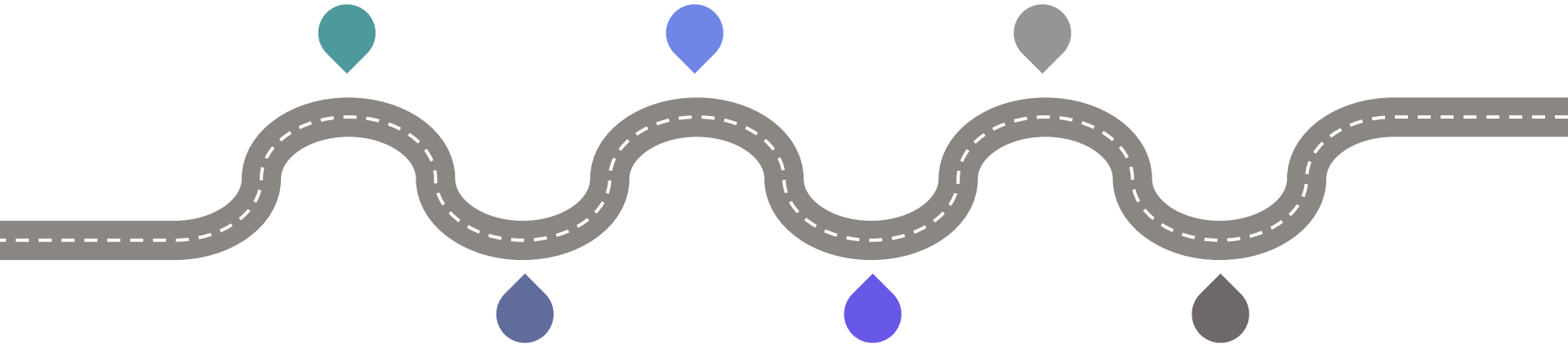
Design learning events, assessments and evaluation plan

Develop training and additional supports for knowledge transfer

Implement framework, event and training supports

Evaluate learning change with assessment and environmental data

Refine framework and design for sustainable maintenance



Sources

This work was influenced by the following resources:

- Toronto Public Library Artificial Intelligence (AI) policy, 2025
- University of Toronto Libraries Framework for AI Literacy, 2025
- EDUCAUSE A Framework for AI Literacy, 2024
- UNESCO Recommendations on the Ethics of AI, 2021
- Canadian Urban Libraries Council AI Glossary (n.d.)
- Canadian Urban Libraries Council AI Prompting Guide (n.d.)
- Canadian Urban Libraries Council AI Staff Competency Framework (n.d.)
- Presentation template by SlidesCarnival